

Hearth OS

Progress report · version 0.22.1 · 30 September 2026

Hearth OS turns a living-room PC into a TV-style home screen for Steam, emulation, streaming apps and Quick Resume, driven by a controller, a TV remote or a Wii Remote. It's built on Bazzite and installs as a system image that updates itself and can always be rolled back. It runs on AMD and Intel graphics; NVIDIA is left for later.

15,008

lines of code

370

automated tests

22

versions released

23

pull requests merged

13

guides in docs/

Since 0.21.0: code +1,502, tests +36. Tested on: Ryzen 7 5800X3D, Radeon RX 6750 XT, 24 GB, 256 GB SATA SSD, Xbox controller, Wii Remotes on a DolphinBar.

What's new in 0.22.1

- **A failed update says why:** `hearthctl update` shows the updater's output as it runs, and Settings → System → Check for updates writes it to `hearthctl logs`, instead of throwing it away.

What's working

Area	What it does	Status
Home screen	TV-style rows, liveries, a backdrop from the focused game, controller batteries and network by the clock	Confirmed on the PC
Emulation	ES-DE with a tile per console; emulators tuned for the GPU and TV	Confirmed on the PC (Dolphin working)
Wii Remote	DolphinBar pointer on the home screen and as a mouse; handed to Dolphin for Wii games	Confirmed on the PC (pointer working)
Quick Resume	Hold Guide to pause a game and pick it up later (up to 3)	Shipped
Quick Menu	Guide button panel: audio, per-app volume, Discord, stats, power, updates, screenshots	Shipped
Streaming	YouTube (VacuumTube), Twitch (VacuumStream), Kodi, Jellyfin, Plex, Moonlight	Shipped
Game stores	Epic Games (Heroic), Battle.net, EA app and Ubisoft Connect (Lutris) tiles; their games in the Library	Shipped
Customising	Favorites with X, move tiles, hide tiles, liveries, sounds	Shipped
Search and details	Search every app and game; Y on a game for play time and last played	Shipped
Settings	Wi-Fi, static IP and DNS, Bluetooth, audio devices, storage (format and use a new drive)	Shipped
Captures	Screenshots from the Quick Menu, a gallery tile, in the screen saver	Shipped
Watch next	Shows and films in progress from Jellyfin, Plex and Kodi; resumes and reports back	Shipped
Family	Daily game-time limit, bedtime and locked tiles behind a PIN	Shipped
Privacy	No ads or tracking; a guide to turn off the TV's own tracking, by make	Shipped
TV control (CEC)	TV on and to the right input on wake and on Guide; standby with the PC	Shipped

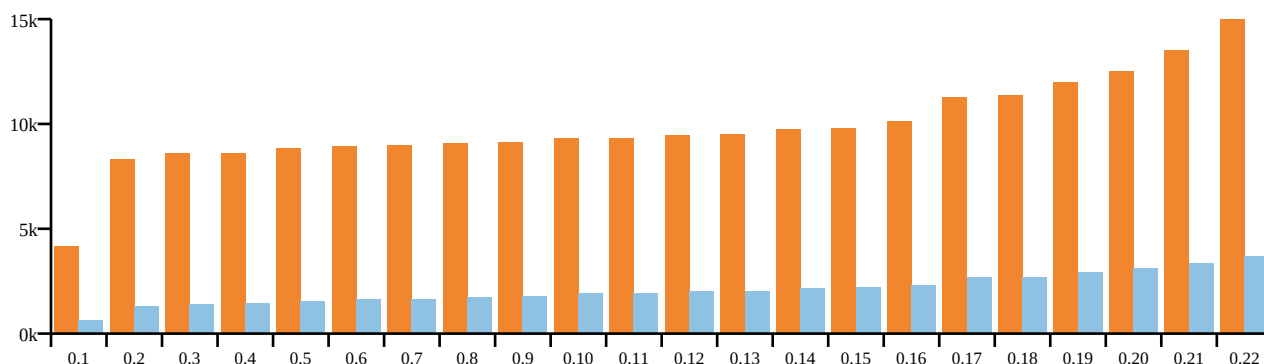
Area	What it does	Status
Performance	Hearth idles under 2% of one core and about 300 MB; hearthctl footprint	Shipped
Updates	Automatic, versioned, with releases on GitHub, a what's-new card and rollback	Shipped
Phone as a remote	A web page with a d-pad and keyboard, paired with a code on the TV	Not started
Profiles, folders	Per-person favorites; groups of tiles	Not started (deferred for now)
NVIDIA graphics	A separate image with NVIDIA's driver	Not started (deferred: AMD and Intel first)
Netflix and similar	DRM limits these to low quality on any home-built PC	Not possible

Confirmed means reported working on the real PC; Shipped means built, tested and released, but not yet reported on.

Lines of code by part

Part	Lines
Home screen, Quick Menu and settings (Python)	12,485
System image (scripts, services, config)	1,141
Build and tools	1,382
Tests	5,243

Growth



Lines of code (orange) and automated tests (blue, ×10) at each version.

Open issues

Issue	Where it stands	What's needed
Steam "Switch to Desktop" can still hang	Holding Guide for 4 s always gets you home; the cause isn't known	hearthctl status and hearthctl logs right after it happens
Recent updates not yet tried on the PC	Built and tested in a virtual display	Update, then try the checklist in the release notes

Next

- Your phone as a remote, with a keyboard for search and Wi-Fi passwords.
- Fix what turns up on the real PC.
- When wanted: profiles and groups of tiles; NVIDIA support.

Every version

Version	Date	Lines of code	Tests	Docs (lines)	Pull requests
0.22.1	2026-09-30	15,008	370	1,559	23
0.21.0	2026-09-29	13,506	334	1,371	23
0.20.0	2026-09-29	12,533	312	1,260	20
0.19.0	2026-09-29	11,984	291	1,120	19
0.18.0	2026-09-29	11,370	270	1,067	18
0.17.0	2026-09-29	11,288	268	1,034	17
0.16.0	2026-09-29	10,159	233	1,022	16
0.15.0	2026-09-29	9,817	223	971	15
0.14.0	2026-09-29	9,741	218	969	14
0.13.0	2026-09-29	9,507	205	954	13
0.12.0	2026-09-27	9,474	201	954	12
0.11.0	2026-09-27	9,339	195	953	11
0.10.0	2026-09-27	9,326	194	940	10
0.9.0	2026-09-27	9,111	179	906	9
0.8.0	2026-09-27	9,072	173	904	8
0.7.0	2026-09-27	8,970	165	901	7
0.6.0	2026-09-27	8,931	163	901	6
0.5.0	2026-09-27	8,836	157	897	5
0.4.0	2026-09-27	8,598	144	888	4
0.3.0	2026-09-27	8,597	141	886	3
0.2.0	2026-09-27	8,336	132	865	2
0.1.0	2026-09-25	4,155	66	703	1